

Lucas Achaval

Tech Lead and Software Engineer in fintech, payments, and stablecoins

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Summary

Tech lead and software engineer with 4 years building systems that move real money, from US banking and stablecoin payments to on-chain automation. Early engineer at Shield (a16z crypto CSX), a fintech that has moved \$600M+ for businesses in 120+ countries. Ships much of the product with AI coding agents like Claude Code and Codex.

Experience

Tech Lead, Shield Jun 2024 – Present

- Remote · Cross-border banking, stablecoin payments, and cards · Backed by a16z crypto CSX, Giant Ventures, Factor Capital
- Joined early and now lead architecture on a small, flat team, directing the AI agents that implement most of the code.
 - Built the stablecoin payments system end to end. It processed \$10M in its first six months.
 - Work across the whole TypeScript stack, from the Fastify API and PostgreSQL to the Next.js dashboard.
 - Set up how we build with AI agents, giving each task its own isolated environment and writing down architecture decisions so agent-written code stays easy to review.
 - Built the controls that protect customer money, like multi-factor payment approval, limits, screening, and account freezes. Worked with compliance to move KYC/KYB onboarding into the product.
 - Manage all AWS infrastructure as code in Terraform, with services running on ECS Fargate. Every PR runs sharded integration tests and Playwright E2E tests.

Blockchain Developer, Self-employed Oct 2022 – May 2024

- Freelance · Remote · Argentina
- Built and ran on-chain automation in production on Ethereum and Layer 2 networks, swapping tokens, bridging assets, and providing liquidity on DeFi protocols through direct smart-contract calls.
 - Handled everything that keeps these systems reliable, from transaction signing, nonces, and gas to RPC providers and failed transactions.
 - Designed and built an algorithmic cryptocurrency trading system from scratch.

Digital Designer & Composite Laminator, ScarlessFolds Jan 2019 – Mar 2020

- Part-time · On-site · Buenos Aires Province, Argentina
- Designed carbon-fiber hydrofoils in Autodesk Fusion 360, CNC-machined their molds, and laminated the final parts.

Education

Universidad Nacional de San Martín (UNSAM) — Bachelor's degree in Data Science	Aug 2023 – Jul 2027 (expected)
University of Buenos Aires (UBA) — Computer Science studies	Mar 2019 – Jul 2023
Goethe Schule Buenos Aires — Trilingual High School Diploma, Natural Sciences	2006 – 2018

Skills

- Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Python, Solidity
Backend: Node.js, Fastify, Express.js, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, OpenAPI, Zod
Frontend and testing: Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS, Vitest, Playwright
Cloud and DevOps: AWS, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, Vercel, Cloudflare
AI engineering: Claude Code, Codex, agentic development workflows
Domain: Payments, stablecoins, KYC/KYB, Ethereum and EVM, Layer 2, DeFi

Languages

Spanish: Native · **English:** Professional (Cambridge B2 First) · **German:** Limited working (DSD II)